AI-POWERED DATA ANALYSIS REPORT

Digital Education in Rural India

Understanding the digital gap, what the data tells us, and how NGOs can help

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1. Introduction

For this task, I chose to study the digital education gap in rural India. Digital tools can help students watch lessons, find information and practise new skills. However, not every student has the same chance to use a phone or computer whenever they need it. A phone may be available in the family, but it may be shared with others or mainly used for purposes other than learning. I used findings from the ASER 2024 report to understand this issue and consider how NGOs could respond.

2. Key findings from ASER 2024

The ASER 2024 survey provides useful information about smartphone access among rural children aged 14–16. The figures below show that access at home is much more common than personal ownership.

89.1%	82.2%	31.4%	57%
Havea smartphone at home	Know how to use a smartphone	Of capable users own a smartphone	Used a phone foran educational activity*

*Among children who reported knowing how to use a smartphone, 57% used one for an educational activity and 76% used one for social media in the week before the survey.

Personal smartphone ownership among children who can use a smartphone



3. What I learned from the data

The figures point to a few important issues:

• **Having a phone at home is not the same as owning one.** Many students may need to share a device, which can make it harder to study at a convenient time.

• **Girls have lower personal ownership in this survey group.** The reported figure was 26.9% for girls and 36.2% for boys, a difference of 9.3 percentage points.

• **There is room to encourage learning-related use.** The survey reports educational use as well as social-media use. These activities can overlap; the figures do not mean students use phones for only one purpose.

Main insight: The digital divide is not only about whether a household has a device. It is also about who can use it, how often they can use it, and whether they have the skills and support to learn with it.

4. Challenges and possible solutions

The solutions below are suggestions based on the research. They are not outcomes measured by the ASER survey.

Challenge	What NGOs and community partners could do
Limited personal access Students may have to share a family device.	Set up community digital-learning spaces with scheduled access to computers or tablets. Where possible, introduce a supervised device-lending programme.
Unequal access for girls The survey shows a gap in personal smartphone ownership.	Run inclusive digital clubs, make sure girls get equal hands-on practice time, and work with families and community leaders to remove barriers.
Learning skills need support Having a smartphone does not automatically mean a student knows how to use it for study.	Offer practical sessions on searching for reliable information, using educational apps, watching lessons and completing simple digital assignments.
Online safety Students need to know how to protect themselves online.	Teach privacy, strong passwords, safe sharing, scam awareness and how to report or block harmful content.
Connectivity and language barriers Online learning may not work well everywhere.	Provide downloadable or offline learning materials, local-language resources and support from trained volunteers or teachers.

5. How an NGO can check whether its programme is working

A digital education programme should be reviewed regularly. An NGO could track a small set of indicators, such as the number of students attending sessions, how many can complete basic digital tasks independently, whether girls and boys receive equal access time, and how many students complete a learning activity using digital resources. A short quiz before and after training can also show whether students have improved their understanding of online safety.

6. Conclusion

This research helped me understand that the digital education gap is more complicated than simply providing internet access. Personal device ownership, equal opportunities, digital skills and online safety all matter. NGOs can make a useful contribution by combining access to devices with hands-on training and ongoing support. The aim should be to help students use technology confidently and meaningfully for their education.

7. References

1. ASER Centre,Annual Status of Education Report (Rural) 2024. https://asercentre.org/aser-2024/
2. Press Information Bureau, Government of India, ASER 2024 findings. https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleseDetailm.aspx?PRID=2099725
3. NITI Aayog,discussion of ASER 2024 smartphone access and gender differences. https://www.niti.gov.in/node/2288

8. Originality and AI-use declaration

This reporthas been written inmy own student-style wording basedon the sources listed above. The statistics and research findings are credited to their original publications. ChatGPT was used as a support tool to organise information, explain findings and improve the structure of the report. The analysis and suggested actions are presented as my interpretation of the published information. I have not intentionally included copied or unattributed material.

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